

dwelling on the past or focusing on what went wrong, as it can negatively affect your game. This straightforward, hands-on approach has worked well for us.

Rather than spending hours in meetings, we address issues individually on the field and act on them. That's the best time to discuss matters with the relevant coaches and fix mistakes. Everyone here has enough experience and knows how to approach the game with the right mindset.

How much do you rely on data versus instinct while bowling?

I'm not in favour of match-ups. Every day, the conditions are different, and that's why people talk about them.

But when you're on the field, you don't think about match-ups. There's no substitute for hitting the right areas — for me, that's the best match-up between a batter and a bowler.

Even if a bowler has dismissed a batter several times before, there's no guarantee of success the next time unless he consistently bowls in the right areas. If you focus too much on how a left-hander bowls to a right-hander, you'll be in a negative frame of mind and won't bowl at your best. So, rather than getting caught up in match-ups, just focus on the basics.

You bowl at a much quicker pace than traditional leg-spinners. Was that a conscious decision, or did it evolve naturally?

It's natural for me. My bowling action and run-up don't allow me to bowl slowly. With the changing nature of wickets, those days when you could bowl slower on turning tracks to deceive the batter are behind us. Nowadays, with batters constantly evolving their game, if you rely solely on slower deliveries, you're bound to get hit for boundaries.

You have to adapt your speed to the situation. On wickets where a target of 230-240 is easily achievable, slow balls become necessary. But otherwise, you need to stick to a quicker pace.

I've always bowled at a faster speed since my early days, and it's just developed over time.

The IPL is known for helping players refine their skills. What's one tactical insight you've gained from the league that changed your game?

The IPL has definitely transformed my game. Since my debut in 2017, it's been a game-changer. It's one of the best leagues in the world.

Performing here completely shifts your mindset and boosts your confidence, which is crucial. If you do well in the IPL, it can take you from zero to hero.

That's certainly been the case for me. Over the years, it has built my confidence and made me a better cricketer.

The IPL is one of the toughest leagues, constantly testing you, which is an invaluable learning experience for any bowler.

How do you see the role of spinners evolving in the next five years?

It's hard to predict exactly, as it all depends on whether the surface offers any support. When there's some assistance for the bowlers, it makes the game more interesting. Bowlers can then utilise their strengths — like the wrong'un or the flipper.

That's when the game becomes beautiful, as batters are also tested. On a sporting wicket, they need to think about how to handle different situations.

In the next five years, it could be a great contest between batters and spinners, but for that to happen, the wickets need to provide something for the bowlers.

IPL CAREER STATS

Matches Played:

131

Wickets Taken:

156

Best Bowling Match (BBM):

4/24

Bowling Average:

23.10

Economy Rate (Econ):

7.02

Strike Rate (SR):

19.75

4-Wicket Hauls:

2